HILCHOT PESAH - SHULHAN ARUKH

Hagalat Kelim Pt. 2: Pans, Glass, Sinks & What You Don't Need to Kasher

Siman 451

Recap of Previous Classes

Class	Simanim	Topics Covered
Class 1	429–432	30 days before Pesach; month of Nisan; Shabbat HaGadol; Bedikat Chametz timing; the bracha
Class 2	432–433	Why "al biur" not "al bedikat"; candle vs torch; where to check; high/low places; hole in walls; synagogues
Class 3	434–437	After Bedikah — bitul night and day; chametz timeline; appointing agents; missed bedikah; renting a house
Class 4	438–440	Mouse/child with chametz; kezayit threshold; kavua principle; non-Jew depositing chametz
Class 5	443–444:1	Chametz on Erev Pesach after six hours; calculating the times; smelling chametz; Erev Pesach on Shabbat (intro)
Class 6	444:2–5, 445	Erev Pesach on Shabbat (continued): bitul/bi'ur schedule; disposing on Shabbat; bi'ur chametz methods
Class 7	446–447:1–2	Finding chametz during Pesach; muktze on Yom Tov; kashrut principles; be-mashehu rule
Class 8	447:4, 5, 10	Chozer ve-ne'or (reawakening); practical implications for hechsherim; noten ta'am li-fgam on Pesach
Class 9	448	Chametz she'avar alav ha-Pesach; mechirat chametz — origins, kinyanim, and practical details
Class 10	451:1–4, 6	Hag'alat Kelim Part 1: Torah sources, libun vs hag'alah, rov tashmisho, earthenware, knives, bowls
Class 11	**451:5, 7–14, 20, 22–26**	**Hag'alat Kelim Part 2: Kli rishon/sheni details, pans and Teflon, handles and lids, covering surfaces, cold absorption, glass**

Siman 451 (Continued)

Se'if 5 — Ke-Volo Kach Polto: Matching the Kashering to the Absorption

Shulchan Aruch: The way a utensil absorbed chametz determines how it must be kashered.

How It Was Used	How to Kasher
Kli Rishon (cooked on fire, or off fire but still boiling — yad soledet bo)	Kasher in a **Kli Rishon** — boiling water on/from the fire
Irui Kli Rishon (hot liquid poured onto it from a pot)	Kasher by **pouring** from a Kli Rishon (irui)
Kli Sheni (received food transferred from a Kli Rishon)	Kasher in a **Kli Sheni** (or of course in a Kli Rishon)

Examples:

- A **ladle/spoon** used to stir a pot on the fire → absorbed as Kli Rishon → must be kashered in a Kli Rishon.
- A **pot** that was on the fire → to kasher, place it inside a bigger pot of boiling water on the fire.
- A **bowl** that received soup poured from the pot → absorbed as irui Kli Rishon → kasher by pouring boiling water over it.

Does Kli Sheni Absorb at All?

Background: We hold (especially Sephardim) that Kli Sheni does not cook (ein Kli Sheni mevashel) — with very few exceptions (kalei ha-bishul: heavily salted fish, pure tea leaves). So why kasher something used only as a Kli Sheni?

Answer: The Shulchan Aruch in Yoreh De'ah (Siman 105) rules that although Kli Sheni doesn't **cook**, there are opinions that it can **absorb and expel** flavor. Since this is a machloket Rishonim, we are machmir le-chatchila (in the first instance) and kasher Kli Sheni items as well.

However: This is only le-chatchila. Be-di'avad — if you didn't kasher a Kli Sheni item and used it on Pesach — the food is fine. You can rely on the lenient opinions.

Kli Shelishi — No Concern at All

A **third vessel** (Kli Shelishi) — e.g., food served with a ladle (Kli Sheni) into a bowl (Kli Shelishi) — does **not** need kashering. Just wash it.

Practical scenario: If you always serve soup using a ladle (not pouring directly from pot to bowl):

Item	Status	Kashering Needed?
The pot	Kli Rishon	✅ Yes — hag'alah in Kli Rishon
The ladle	Kli Sheni (if plastic/non-conducting)	✅ Le-chatchila — in Kli Sheni or Rishon
The bowl	Kli Shelishi	❌ No — just wash
Spoons used in the bowl	Kli Shelishi	❌ No — just wash

Note on metal ladles: Some Poskim say a metal ladle sitting in a hot pot takes on the status of Kli Rishon (because metal conducts). This is itself a machloket. Combined with the doubt about whether Kli Sheni absorbs at all → safek sefeika (double doubt) → one can be lenient.

Kashering On vs. Off the Fire

- **Shulchan Aruch:** A Kli Rishon can be kashered in another Kli Rishon, even off the fire (as long as it's still boiling).
- **Later Poskim (what we do in practice):** If the utensil was used **on the fire**, it should ideally be kashered in water that is **on the fire** — not just boiling water that's been taken off.
- **In practice at communal hag'alah events:** The fire is kept on underneath the pot throughout. At home: keep the stove burner on while kashering pots.

Kashering by Pouring (Irui) — Practical Rules for Sinks

Since sinks absorb chametz through irui (hot water poured from pots hits the sink walls), they are kashered by irui — pouring boiling water over them.

Two critical rules for effective irui:

Rule 1: Direct, unbroken stream (nitzok)

- The boiling water must hit the surface in a **direct, continuous stream** — not splash, drip, or run down from another surface.
- If you pour onto the walls and it runs down to the basin — that does **not** kasher the basin. You must pour **directly** onto the basin.
- **Practical order:** Start with the **base/basin** of the sink (pour directly in circular motions), then work up the **walls/sides**.

Rule 2: The surface must be dry

- Irui can only kasher a **dry** surface. If there is cold water pooled on the surface, the boiling water loses its ability to kasher upon contact with the cold water.
- This is another reason to start from the **base** first — if you start from the walls, water runs down and pools at the base, which you'd then need to dry before kashering the base.

Se'if 7 — Ivory Utensils (Precious Materials)

Shulchan Aruch: Spoons or utensils made from ivory (keren) — cannot be kashered.

Why? Not because hag'alah doesn't work on ivory in principle, but because ivory is so **precious and delicate** that the owner won't do hag'alah properly — they won't heat the water high enough or dip it in fully, for fear of damaging it.

This is a Rabbinic concern, not from the Gemara — the Rishonim added this safeguard.

Modern application: Difficult to think of a parallel today. Any utensil so expensive you'd be afraid to boil properly? Possibly certain decorative items — but if you only use them cold, no kashering is needed anyway.

Se'if 8 — Materials That Can Be Kashered

Shulchan Aruch: The following materials can all be kashered normally (hag'alah or libun as appropriate):

- **Wood**
- **Stone** (including quartz)
- **Metal**
- **Bone**

Practical relevance: Quartz sinks and countertops — these are stone and can be kashered. People building kitchens who want to use the same sink for Pesach: quartz is fine, kasher it normally.

Se'if 10 — Baskets Used for Salting Meat: Ein Machzikin Issura

Shulchan Aruch: Baskets used for salting meat — two opinions on whether they need kashering:

Opinion	Reasoning
First opinion: Need hag'alah	Perhaps chametz crumbs were mixed in with the meat during salting. Heavy salting can absorb and extract even cold.
Second opinion (halacha): No kashering needed	**Ein machzikin issura** — we don't assume chametz is lurking where there's no evidence of it.

The Shulchan Aruch rules like the second opinion. If you **know** there was chametz, kasher it. If you don't know — don't assume it.

This is the same principle from Siman 447:5 — ein machzikin issura. Combined with chozer ve-ne'or (Class 8), these are the two reasons why plain ingredients before Pesach don't need a hechsher.

Plastic

Modern question: What is the status of plastic?

Opinion	View
Extreme opinion	Plastic = like glass (zechuchit). For Ashkenazim who can't kasher glass → can't kasher plastic either.
General consensus	Plastic either doesn't absorb at all (most logical scientifically), or it can be kashered normally.
In practice	We kasher plastic. It works. The opinion that it can't be kashered is not followed.

Se'if 11 — Frying Pans: The Rosh vs. the Rashba

Shulchan Aruch: A pan used for frying with oil — can be kashered with **hag'alah**.

If it's very long and doesn't fit in a pot → do hag'alah on the sides, libun in the middle section.

The Core Machloket:

Opinion	Ruling	Reasoning
The Rosh (Shulchan Aruch follows)	Hag'alah suffices for frying pans	Even though oil sometimes burns and dries up, there's always **some moisture** (lachluchit) remaining. As long as you cook with oil/liquid, it's considered wet absorption → hag'alah.
The Rashba (Rama follows)	Needs libun	Sometimes the oil dries completely, the food burns → those moments are dry absorption → needs libun.

The Rama's compromise: Because of the combination of (a) Rabbeinu Tam — chametz is hetera bala anyway, plus (b) the Rosh's opinion that hag'alah suffices → the Rama allows **libun kal** (a lighter form of libun = putting it in the oven at high temperature for about 30 minutes).

For Sephardim: Hag'alah suffices for regular frying pans. Full stop.

Teflon / Non-Stick Pans

The problem: The entire purpose of non-stick pans is to cook **without liquid** — minimal or no oil. This is genuinely dry cooking.

Approach	Reasoning
Strict (recommended)	Non-stick = truly dry → needs libun. Libun will likely destroy the pan. Better to put it away and buy a Pesach one.
Those who do hag'alah	Not necessarily wrong — because: (1) hetera bala (Rabbeinu Tam) in the background; (2) is it really 100% dry? Some oil is still used; (3) what counts as libun? Maybe oven suffices. Multiple leniencies combine.

Practical advice: Non-stick Teflon pans — put them away for Pesach. This is one of the few things worth buying new.

Oven Trays / Cake Tins

Mishnah Berurah (65): Baking trays (tavnit) — used completely dry in the oven — need **libun** to kasher. Cannot be kashered with hag'alah.

- Libun at highest oven temperature may ruin them.
- **Practical advice:** Put oven trays away and use Pesach ones, or line with foil.

Oil Temperature Question

Interesting question raised: Oil fries at much higher temperatures than 100°C (boiling water). Shouldn't we need hotter water to extract what went in through hot oil?

Answer: None of the Poskim ever raised this concern. In practice, we use boiling water for hag'alah regardless. The question deserves investigation scientifically, but halachically, hag'alah with boiling water has always been accepted for oil-based absorption.

Se'if 12 — Handles of Utensils

Shulchan Aruch: You must also kasher the **handles** of utensils — not just the cooking surface.

Why?

- **Metal handles:** Metal conducts heat — forbidden flavor travels through the pot walls into the handle.
- **Non-metal handles (wood, etc.):** The Mishnah Berurah asks: why? Perhaps hot chametz touches the handle during washing, or your chametz-covered hands grip it while cooking. Some concern of absorption.

The Rama says: If you **didn't** kasher the handles — be-di'avad, the pot and its contents are still fine.

His reasoning: The same heat that travels from the pot to the handle during cooking also travels during kashering — so the handle gets kashered automatically along with the pot.

In practice: We do kasher handles (le-chatchila). But if you missed them — no need to re-do.

Se'if 14 — Lids

Shulchan Aruch: Lids of pots **must** be kashered.

Why? The lid receives **evaporation and steam** (zei'ah) from the food cooking below. This steam carries chametz flavor and absorbs into the lid.

If you placed an un-kashered lid on a Pesach pot on Pesach:

Timing	Consequence
On Pesach itself	All contents of the pot are **forbidden** — because on Pesach, even a drop of chametz is be-mashehu (no bitul)
On Erev Pesach after chatzot	Fine — if there's 60 times more food than the absorbed flavor (likely). Everyone agrees 1-in-60 works from chatzot until Pesach itself.
Lid not used for 24 hours	Sephardim: noten ta'am li-fgam — be-di'avad, the food is permitted.

Se'if 20 — The Origin of Covering Surfaces

Shulchan Aruch: Tables and storage boxes/cupboards where food is kept all year round — we pour hot water (irui) onto them to kasher, because sometimes soup spills from a pot onto the table.

Key insight: If you **never bring pots to the table** (only bowls — which are Kli Sheni), there is **no need to kasher the table** at all. A spill from a Kli Sheni onto the table is not a concern.

Where Does "Covering" Come From?

Magen Avraham: Even after kashering the table, put a tablecloth on it — perhaps some chametz remains.

The Rama and Eliyahu Rabbah disagree: For flat tables — not necessary. Just kasher it.

Eliyahu Rabbah (cited in Mishnah Berurah): For **cupboards, shelves, fridge, freezer** — where food sits directly on surfaces and it's very hard to clean every trace — **cover them**.

This is the origin of the entire practice of covering surfaces for Pesach.

Modern Application

Surface	What's Needed
Dining table	If pots come to the table: kasher with irui (or cover). If only bowls/plates: just wash.
Kitchen counters	Kasher with irui (hot spills from Kli Rishon likely during the year). Or cover.
Fridge / freezer shelves	If you place **unwrapped** food directly on them: cover the shelves. If all food is **wrapped/packaged**: no need to cover — just wash well.
Cupboard shelves	Same as fridge: cover if unwrapped food sits on them; wash if everything is packaged.

Important: Nowadays we have extensive plastic packaging. The old concern was about unwrapped food sitting directly on surfaces. If your food is packaged, much of the covering is unnecessary.

Se'if 22 — Cold Chametz and the Two Exceptions

Shulchan Aruch: All utensils — even earthenware — that were used **only with cold chametz** throughout the year → can be used on Pesach for even hot food. Just wash them.

Two exceptions where cold chametz still creates a problem:

Exception 1: Beit Se'or (Place of Extended Contact)

- If chametz dough sat on a surface for **24 consecutive hours** (me'et le'et) — it absorbs even though it's cold.
- This is the principle of **kavush ke-mevushal** — prolonged soaking/contact is equivalent to cooking.
- Example: A kneading board where dough sits overnight.

Exception 2: Beit Charoset (Sharp Ingredients)

- If chametz was used together with **sharp ingredients** (davar charif) — garlic, onion, ginger — even cold, even without 24 hours.
- Sharp foods have the ability to cause absorption and extraction even when cold.
- Example: Cutting onions and bread together with a knife.

Even with these exceptions:

- The utensil **can be kashered** (hag'alah for non-earthenware).
- Even without kashering — it can be used for **cold food** on a one-off (temporary) basis.
- Earthenware with these issues: cannot be kashered → don't use on Pesach.

Practical example: A knife used to cut onions on bread (cold, but sharp ingredient + chametz together) → needs hag'alah. A knife used to cut bread alone (cold, no sharp) → just wash it.

Se'if 23 — Glazed Earthenware (China)

Shulchan Aruch: Earthenware vessels covered with a glass glaze — have the status of **earthenware** (cannot be kashered).

Why? Even though glass doesn't absorb, when the glass glaze is fired together with the earthenware during manufacturing, it becomes porous along with the clay. The glaze doesn't provide independent protection.

Critical distinction — glass on ovens/hobs:

Scenario	Status	Kashering?
Glazed china (glass fused with clay during manufacturing)	= Earthenware	❌ Cannot be kashered
Glass cooktop / induction hob (separate glass panel on top)	= Glass	✅ Just clean well with soap — no kashering needed
Oven door glass (separate glass panel)	= Glass	✅ Just clean — no kashering needed

This is a very common misconception. People think they need to kasher their glass induction hob or oven glass. You don't — it's glass, it's a separate item, not glazed earthenware. Just clean it thoroughly.

Se'if 25 — Drinking Cups and Mugs

Shulchan Aruch: All drinking vessels — whether glass, wood, metal, or even earthenware — can be used on Pesach just by **washing**. No kashering needed.

Even if during the year, hot chametz was occasionally placed in them (e.g., a child poured hot soup with croutons into a cup).

Why? Because the **rov tashmisho** (majority use) of cups and drinking vessels is with **cold** liquids. We follow the majority.

Modern application — mugs:

Usage Pattern	Kashering Needed?
Used for coffee/tea throughout the year; once or twice had hot soup with chametz	❌ No — just wash. Rov tashmisho is cold/non-chametz drinks.
Regularly used for porridge, hot chametz soups, etc.	✅ Yes — needs hag'alah (rov tashmisho is hot chametz)
Used only for cold water and cold drinks	❌ No — just wash

The Rav's emphasis: This saves significant money and effort. People buy new cups and glasses for Pesach unnecessarily. If you understand rov tashmisho, most drinking vessels in your home need nothing more than a good wash.

Se'if 26 — Glass (זכוכית)

Famous machloket:

Opinion	Ruling	Reasoning
Shulchan Aruch (Sephardim)	Glass **does not absorb** at all. Even used with hot chametz all year → just wash and use on Pesach.	Glass is non-porous — it doesn't take in flavors.
Rama (Ashkenazim)	Glass is **like earthenware** — so porous it can't even be kashered with hag'alah. Cannot be used on Pesach if used with chametz.	Glass is a form of sand/earth — similar to clay.

For Sephardim: Glass is the ultimate solution. A set of glass dishes, cups, and cookware can be used for meat, milk, and Pesach — year-round. Just wash between uses. No kashering, no separate sets needed.

Practical tip from the Rav: For people who struggle with the expense of multiple sets of dishes — invest in glass. One set works for everything: meat, dairy, and Pesach. This is fully halachically valid for Sephardim.

Summary of Key Practical Takeaways

Item	What's Needed for Pesach
Pots used on fire	Hag'alah in Kli Rishon (keep fire on underneath)
Ladles/spoons (stirring pots)	Hag'alah in Kli Rishon
Bowls (served with ladle)	Kli Shelishi — just wash
Cutlery (used in bowls)	Kli Shelishi — just wash (le-chatchila: hag'alah)
Frying pans (with oil)	Sephardim: hag'alah. Ashkenazim: libun kal (oven, high temp, 30 min)
Non-stick / Teflon pans	Put away — buy Pesach ones
Oven trays / cake tins	Need libun — usually easier to put away or line with foil
Sinks	Irui — pour boiling water directly; start from base, then walls; surface must be dry
Kitchen counters	Irui (pour boiling water) or cover
Tables	If pots come to table: irui or cover. If only bowls: just wash.
Fridge / cupboard shelves	Cover if unwrapped food sits on them. If packaged: just wash.
Drinking cups / glasses	Just wash — rov tashmisho is cold
Mugs	Usually just wash — unless regularly used with hot chametz
Glass (Sephardim)	Just wash — glass doesn't absorb
Glass (Ashkenazim)	Cannot be used — like earthenware
Glazed china	Cannot be kashered — = earthenware
Glass cooktop / induction hob	Just clean well with soap — it's glass, not glazed china
Handles	Le-chatchila: kasher them. Be-di'avad if missed: fine.
Lids	Must kasher — absorbs steam
Plastic	Can be kashered — hag'alah works
Quartz sinks/counters	= Stone — can be kashered normally

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